

THE INCLUSION EDIT

# Brand Voice Guide.

Tone, language, audiences and microcopy for the website, the Impact Platform, learning materials, resources and Inclusion AI.

Approved by Rebekah Hayward, 6 November 2026 · Live version: claude.ai/artifact/8TYUkU2bSEyySrM5ZBeGcY

**Status: approved by Rebekah Hayward, 6 November 2026.** Part three of the brand system, alongside the Brand World and the Visual Brand Guide.

Open the others: Brand World and Visual Brand Guide.

# Our voice

**The Inclusion Edit sounds like an experienced, thoughtful inclusion leader who makes complex issues understandable, challenges people constructively and helps them turn insight into action.** It never sounds like a generic EDI consultancy, an academic textbook, a corporate HR department or an AI assistant.

**In one statement:** we communicate with intelligence, warmth, confidence, curiosity and conviction. We make complex inclusion issues understandable without oversimplifying them, challenge assumptions constructively, recognise the human experiences behind organisational issues and connect evidence to practical action. We help people think differently, understand more deeply and act with purpose.

**Keep the personality.** Polish should make Rebekah's warmth, conviction, curiosity and willingness to challenge clearer, never dilute them. Humour and lightness have a place when they feel natural.

Our voice should leave people thinking: these people understand inclusion and the realities of organisations; they explain it clearly; they are credible and evidence-informed; they are not afraid to challenge the status quo; they make complex issues manageable; they care about change, not appearances.

## Five defining characteristics

| Characteristic | We sound like | We do | We avoid |
|---|---|---|---|
| Intelligent and insightful | An experienced professional who can explain their subject so it makes people think | Use research, experience and real examples; explain specialist terms rather than avoid them | Academic language to sound clever, jargon, unsupported claims, oversimplifying |
| Warm and human | A knowledgeable, approachable person who cares about the subject and the people affected | Make space for curiosity without embarrassment; recognise the human impact of decisions and systems | Cold corporate language, over-familiarity, forced enthusiasm, patronising explanations |
| Confident and challenging | An inclusion leader prepared to challenge the status quo and explain why change matters | Say when something is not working; challenge ideas, structures and behaviours constructively; never dilute an important message | Aggression, moral grandstanding, leaving no room to learn |
| Curious and thought-provoking | Someone who opens up a conversation and introduces a different perspective | Use questions, scenarios and observations; invite reflection rather than telling people what to think | Presenting every issue as simple; assuming everyone starts from the same place |
| Practical and action-oriented | A professional who turns a complex issue into clear, achievable next steps | Explain what it is, why it matters and what to do; respect limited time and budgets | Vague recommendations, empty motivation, problems without possible solutions |

**The test:** read it aloud. If it sounds like Rebekah talking to a client over coffee, it is right. If it sounds like a strategy document, rewrite it.

## The balance we hold

Intelligent but accessible. Confident but not arrogant. Warm but not overly familiar. Thought-provoking but not needlessly provocative. Professional but not corporate. Encouraging without being patronising.

**We are values-led and willing to challenge.** We discuss difficult subjects, question established practice and never dilute an important message to make it comfortable. We say it constructively and thoughtfully, so people can hear it.

**The balance:** human, not informal; confident, not self-important; personal, not overly familiar. We share observations, tell stories, express a point of view, celebrate progress, acknowledge challenges and recognise the people doing this work. We should never sound as if every sentence passed through a corporate communications department.

## Warm, but never patronising

**Our voice is warm, approachable and human, but never patronising.** We make complex inclusion concepts accessible without oversimplifying them or talking down to our audience. People come to this work with different levels of knowledge and experience; we meet them where they are while keeping the depth, credibility and seriousness the subject deserves. This matters most when we discuss racism, discrimination, inequality and organisational harm: warmth never softens the facts, and authority never turns cold.

In practice we: make people feel welcome, supported and capable; explain complex ideas without making anyone feel unintelligent; never assume a lack of knowledge; and balance warmth with authority in every piece.

## Speak to the reality of the work

**We communicate with an understanding of what inclusion work is really like.** Our audience may be passionate about change but short on time, resources, confidence or organisational support. We acknowledge those challenges without making people feel overwhelmed or inadequate. Our language should leave people informed, capable, supported and ready to take their next step.

We write with real people in mind, for example: an experienced EDI professional working alone; an HR manager who has suddenly been handed responsibility for inclusion; a People Lead trying to win leadership buy-in; a manager who wants a more inclusive team but does not know where to start. Each should feel that we understand their day.

# Who we speak to: the person carrying inclusion (approved 10 November 2026)

**We write first for the person carrying inclusion in their organisation, largely alone:** the person leading it or doing the inclusion work, often without the title, team or budget to match. Their organisation's decision maker, the approver, is a second reader we serve in clearly separate moments, never in the same breath. The full customer brief is saved in the project as "The Person Carrying Inclusion".

## How we describe them

We describe them by what they do, never by a title, so every reader recognises themselves.

| | |
|---|---|
| Use | The person carrying inclusion. The person leading inclusion. The person doing the inclusion work. Or simply you, followed by the situation they face |
| Avoid as labels | Inclusion champion (sounds like a volunteer side project); inclusion lead or practitioner as a public label (reads as a job title that excludes some readers) |
| Where each fits | Headlines and subheadlines: the person carrying inclusion. Body copy: you. Approver section: the person leading inclusion at your organisation, or the colleague carrying it |
| Pronouns | They, them and you. Never he or she |

**They might be** a dedicated EDI or inclusion lead (often the only one, or one of two), an HR or People professional with inclusion added to a wider role, or someone running an employee network alongside their day job. Most often in organisations of roughly 50 to 1,000 people, in professional and financial services, housing, health, local government, education, charities and construction.

## Their situation, in their own terms

Use these as the emotional truth behind the copy, in plain language, never as a checklist.

- **Spinning plates:** organisation wide responsibility with a small team or none. Tested line: you are not just spinning plates on your own anymore.
- **Isolation:** no peers inside the organisation who do what they do; they want community and connection.
- **No defensible budget line:** often no inclusion budget at all; sign off can run through four or five people for a small spend.
- **Time:** capacity is the constraint, more than knowledge.
- **Needing evidence to influence upward:** they must persuade leaders who may not yet care.
- **Political caution:** visible EDI spend, and the term EDI itself, can draw pushback, so what we write must be safe to forward.
- **Tired of tick box:** one off training and certificates that change nothing.

**What they want:** practical tools they can use the same day; evidence and a business case to take to leadership; to feel less alone, with a real person and peers; to look capable and credible in front of their leaders; visible progress they can

report; something between an expensive consultant and a folder of templates.

## How we speak to them

- **As a capable professional doing hard work, never as someone who needs rescuing.** Acknowledge the load without pity.
- **Two registers, kept visibly separate.** For the person carrying inclusion: warm, direct and emotionally accurate. For the approver (HR director, chief people officer or chief executive): formal, outcome led and numerate, in its own clearly marked section.
- **Every ask is value driven:** say what they get in return.
- **Honest on claims:** only stats and proof points we can stand behind, with short attribution.
- **The forward test:** can the person carrying inclusion forward this to their director without editing, and would the director find a reason to act in it? If both are true, the balance is right.

## Words that work, and words to avoid

| | |
|---|---|
| Lean into | Capacity (the strongest anchor word). Carrying inclusion; not alone; practical; evidence you can take to leadership; real person; embedded; business case. Plain, specific, grown up language |
| Use with care | Capability: some readers hear it as implying they lack skill, so test it by audience (it stays in the tagline). EDI and DEI: use sparingly and lead with outcomes (culture, productivity, retention, creativity, risk) rather than the acronym |
| Avoid | Initiatives (use inclusion projects and strategy). Dashboard as a word in copy (it collided with internal jargon in discovery calls). Tick box, except to describe what we are not. Anything that sounds like an employee assistance programme: community feels like peers, not therapy. Guilt, shaming or moralising. Corporate or academic tone. Dashes of any kind |

**Not yet proven, so do not build headline copy on it:** the HR generalist with inclusion newly added, and the founder or manager wearing the hat, were not directly tested. Treat them as versions of the person carrying inclusion until more calls confirm. Never invent customer quotes or statistics.

# Tone dials

The voice stays the same; the tone moves. Set four dials for each piece before you write.

| Situation | Formal / Casual | Challenging / Reassuring | Expert / Personal | Concise / Expansive |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Proposal or business case | Formal | Balanced | Expert | Concise |
| Website page | Middle | Balanced | Expert | Concise |
| LinkedIn post | Middle | Challenging | Personal | Middle |
| Instagram or TikTok | Casual | Challenging | Personal | Concise |
| Platform dashboard and UI | Middle | Reassuring | Expert | Very concise |
| Foundation Lesson | Middle | Reassuring | Expert | Concise |
| Inclusion AI output | Middle | Reassuring | Expert | Concise |
| Difficult topic (backlash, harm, grief) | Middle | Reassuring | Personal | Expansive enough to be careful |
| Error or failed payment | Middle | Reassuring | Expert | Very concise |

**Tone by context** (the tone shifts; the personality stays recognisable):

| Context | Tone |
|---|---|
| Website | Confident, clear, welcoming, credible |
| Impact Platform | Accessible, encouraging, engaging, informative: an experienced learning partner |
| Learning materials | Educational, thoughtful, practical, conversational |
| LinkedIn | Insightful, confident, human, thought-provoking, with a clear point of view |
| Research and reports | Evidence-informed, precise, professional, analytical |
| Consultancy proposals | Strategic, credible, clear, commercially aware |
| Training presentations | Engaging, accessible, confident, reflective |
| Newsletters | Warm, personal, considered, useful |
| Podcast: For the Love of EDI | Conversational, curious, authentic, knowledgeable; never a scripted presentation |
| Marketing | Clear, persuasive, confident, value-led |
| Audio, narration and video voiceover | Natural, warm, confident, professional; considered for serious topics, more conversational for lighter ones |

# Writing style rules

These rules apply to every piece of content, copy, code comment and commit message.

**Punctuation**

- **No dashes anywhere.** No em dashes and no en dashes in sentences. Use a colon, a semicolon, a comma, or rewrite. Hyphenated compound words are fine (follow-up, award-winning).
- Number ranges: write "30 to 45 minutes" in copy. The platform code currently allows an en dash in ranges; this guide recommends words so the rule stays simple.
- One exclamation mark per piece, at most. Usually none.
- Arrows (→) are allowed for short social lists only.
- No emojis in professional content: headings, platform navigation, resource cards, training materials, presentations, reports, branded graphics or calls to action. Emojis belong only in social captions, used sparingly, with the medium-dark skin tone modifier on skin-relevant emojis.

**Spelling and grammar**

- British English throughout: organisation, colour, programme, prioritise, behaviour, judgement.
- Write numbers as figures from 10 upwards and for all stats and percentages (62%, 5%). Spell out one to nine in prose.
- Dates: 4 November 2026. Time: 9:30am.
- Use contractions (you're, it's, don't). They sound human.

**Capitalisation**

- Hero headings, section headings and buttons: Title Case ("Start Your Membership").
- Body copy, card text, form labels, error messages: sentence case.
- Eyebrow pills and badges: ALL CAPS, short ("MEMBERS ONLY").
- Product names are always capitalised: Impact Platform, Inclusion AI, Foundation Lessons, Evidence Builder, Make the Case.

**Structure**

- Sentences under 25 words. Paragraphs of one to three sentences.
- Lead with the point. The first sentence says what matters.
- Cards and slides: one punchy line of body text where possible; slides never more than 5 to 6 lines.
- Use the Rule of Three for lists, promises and key messages.
- Close social posts and many articles with one genuine question.
- Stat sources are short and attribution-style: "CIPD, 2025", not full citations.
- Bullets in documents only for parallel items. Conversational replies are prose.

**Rhythm and shape**

- Vary sentence length. Use a short, direct statement when the point matters most.
- Never repeat the same point in slightly different words.
- Headings say what the reader will learn, never something that only sounds impressive.
- **Open with something relevant:** a real organisational challenge, an observation, a question, a misconception, a research finding or a situation the reader recognises. Never a generic warm-up.
- **Close with something useful:** a next step, a reflection question, a recommendation, the central insight or an invitation to continue the conversation. Not every piece ends in a sales pitch.

# Sounding expert and warm

People judge organisations on warmth and competence, and for buyers competence decides (see the Brand World). Our warmth comes naturally, so our words must make expertise unmistakable.

| Sounds competent | Sounds unsure or generic |
|---|---|
| "Across the [number] organisations we've worked with, the barrier is rarely intent. It's time." | "Many organisations may sometimes find that..." |
| Specific numbers, named methods, named sectors | Stacked hedges: might, perhaps, possibly |
| A clear recommendation with the reason | A list of options with no view |
| Naming the trade-off honestly | Promising it will be easy |
| "Here's what we'd do first." | "There are many ways to approach this." |

Warmth is added through recognition and respect, never through softening the substance: name the difficulty, credit the reader's experience, then be clear. Be confident without over-apologising, and uncertain only where the evidence genuinely is. Fill bracketed numbers only with real figures.

# I and we

- **"I"** for Rebekah's own channels, founder posts, newsletters and videos: personal experience, opinion and story.
- **"We"** for The Inclusion Edit: the website, platform, proposals, resources and Inclusion AI.
- Never mix the two in one piece. Team members speak as themselves on their own channels and as "we" in company content.

# Message house

**Positioning statement:** for the person carrying inclusion in their organisation, and the organisations they serve, The Inclusion Edit is the expert partner that gives them the capacity, evidence and real human support to turn good intentions into practical, measurable change, through consultancy, training and the Impact Platform, so inclusion becomes part of how the organisation works.

| Pillar | What it means | Proof to use |
|---|---|---|
| Capacity | We give stretched people time back: ready-to-use tools, templates and support | Resource library, Inclusion AI tools, office hours |
| Capability | We build knowledge and confidence across leaders, managers and teams | Foundation Lessons, modules, training, testimonials |
| Change | We help organisations evidence what changed, not just what was delivered | Case studies, business case tools, outcome data |

**In 10 words:** expert inclusion support that turns good intentions into change.

**In 30 seconds:** most organisations want to be inclusive; few give the person carrying it the time, team or budget to make it stick. We give that person capacity first (practical tools, evidence and a real person to call on), then the capability to lead with confidence, then change they can show their leaders, through consultancy, training and our Impact Platform. They are not meant to do this alone.

# Gains-based framing and core messages

**Write about what the reader gains, not what we offer.** "You gain confidence, not just knowledge" beats "We deliver training".

| Instead of (offer) | Write (gain) |
|---|---|
| We offer a resource library | You get ready-to-use tools for tomorrow's meeting |
| Our AI tools generate reports | Walk into your next sign-off meeting with the case already made |
| We deliver EDI training | Your managers leave knowing exactly what to do differently on Monday |
| Membership includes office hours | You're not carrying this on your own anymore |
| Access to inclusion resources | Find credible resources you can put into practice |
| AI-powered inclusion tools | Turn your inclusion challenges into practical next steps |
| Learning modules | Build the knowledge and confidence to take action |
| Case studies | Learn what has worked elsewhere and how to apply it in your organisation |
| Business case resources | Make a stronger, evidence-informed case for inclusion |

**Core messages** (reuse, adapt, never contradict):

1. **Capacity. Capability. Change.** The promise, always in that order.
2. **From good intentions to lasting inclusion.** What we help organisations do.
3. **Inclusion is structural, intentional and ongoing.** What we believe.
4. **You're not spinning plates on your own anymore.** What the inclusion lead feels.
5. **Responsibility without resource isn't a strategy.** What we tell leaders.
6. **Somewhere between an expensive consultant and a folder of templates.** Where we sit.
7. **The business case is real:** productivity, retention, creativity, profit and the cost of rehiring. Lead with it for budget holders.

# Terminology

## Our own names

| Use | Not |
|---|---|
| The Inclusion Edit (always "The", capital T) | Inclusion Edit, TIE in public copy |
| Impact Platform, or "the platform" | the hub, the membership hub, Resource Platform |
| Inclusion AI | the AI, chatbot, bot |
| Foundation Lessons | Quick Lessons |
| members | users, customers (inside the platform) |
| Free Inclusion Call | discovery call, sales call (in public copy) |
| inclusion lead, EDI lead, EDI practitioner | diversity officer, D&I champion (unless that is their title) |

## Sector language

- **EDI** (equity, diversity and inclusion) is our default for UK and Bermuda audiences. Spell it out on first use in long-form content.
- **DEI** or **DEIB** for US audiences and US-facing SEO. Hashtags can carry both.
- Where the climate is cautious, lead with **inclusion**, **belonging**, **fairness** or **people and culture**. The work is the same; the word should fit the reader's context (discovery calls showed teams renaming away from "diversity").
- Test our own wording with the audience: "capacity" and "capability" land differently depending on the reader. Never assume one word works for everyone.
- Avoid internal jargon that may collide with a client's: say "your learning record" or "your progress" before "dashboard" in marketing copy.

## People and identity

Name people as they name themselves; when unsure, be specific and ask.

| Prefer | Avoid |
|---|---|
| disabled people (UK social model); person-first if the individual or US audience prefers | the disabled, handicapped, suffering from, wheelchair-bound |
| name the specific group (Black colleagues, South Asian women) | BAME, minorities as a catch-all |
| underrepresented, marginalised (when describing systems) | diverse as a label for a person ("a diverse hire") |
| neurodivergent people, autistic people | high or low functioning |
| LGBTQ+ people; use people's pronouns | homosexual, preferred pronouns, lifestyle |
| lived experience | "the voice of" a whole community |
| older workers, people over 50 | the elderly |

| Prefer | Avoid |
| --- | --- |
| reasonable adjustments (UK), accommodations (US) | special treatment |

## Language to avoid

Generic phrases that could belong to any consultancy or any AI tool:

- "In today's ever-changing landscape" / "In an increasingly diverse world" / "In today's fast-paced world"
- "Unlock the power of diversity" / "Embrace the journey" / "Let's dive in" / "At the end of the day"
- "Game-changing solutions" / "Transformative synergies" / "Navigate the landscape"
- "Empowering people to be their authentic selves" without real context
- "We are passionate about diversity and inclusion" instead of saying what we do
- "A seat at the table" when the issue is more than representation

Words to use sparingly, never as a substitute for being specific: journey, transformational, empower (prefer "equip"), unlock, holistic, dynamic, seamless, game-changing, revolutionary, leverage, synergy, utilise, best-in-class, world-class, cutting-edge, and "meaningful impact" without saying what the impact is. "Tick-box" only when critiquing it.

## Language principles

**Clear and accessible.** Short, purposeful sentences, active verbs, meaningful examples, descriptive headings. Explain every acronym on first use and every specialist term where it appears. Respect the reader's intelligence.

**Inclusive and respectful.** Respect identities and experiences; avoid stereotypes and assumptions; never define people solely by a protected characteristic; never present one person's experience as representative of a whole group. Where terminology is evolving or contested, explain the context rather than presenting it as settled.

**Systems, not just individuals.** Inclusion is shaped by policies, processes, structures, culture and leadership decisions as well as attitudes. Where it fits, talk about structural barriers, institutional practice, power and privilege, access to opportunity, decision-making and accountability. Never place responsibility solely on individuals when the issue is organisational.

**Evidence used responsibly.** Credible sources, checked at the original where possible, with dates and context. Never present correlation as causation, overstate what a study shows, or use a statistic only because it makes a better headline. Separate findings from interpretation. Our credibility depends on accuracy.

## Our vocabulary

Words that belong to us, used with purpose rather than forced in: inclusion, equity, belonging, fairness, accessibility, representation, opportunity, accountability, organisational culture, psychological safety, participation, lived experience, intersectionality, structural barriers, systemic change, evidence, impact, progress, action, reflection, curiosity, responsibility.

Ideas we return to, so people recognise how we think:

- Moving beyond good intentions; turning awareness into action.
- Understanding the systems behind people's experiences.
- Making inclusion part of how organisations operate.

- Creating fairer access to opportunity, and cultures where people contribute and thrive.
- Turning evidence and insight into practical action.
- Inclusion is everyone's responsibility, and accountability must be clear.

# Speaking to each audience

**Guiding principle: no one should feel they need to be an inclusion expert before they can engage with our work.** Our standing audience is the person carrying inclusion (see Who we speak to); the rows below are the forms they and the people around them take. Most pages speak to two people: the person carrying inclusion, who reads most of the site, and the approver, who needs a short, separate, outcome led case. Keep the two visibly apart.

| Audience | What they are looking for | How we speak to them | Avoid | Example line |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Individual inclusion practitioner (EDI role, consultant, developing expert) | New perspectives, tools, professional development, evidence, ideas to apply | As a knowledgeable professional; deepen what they already know; invite exploration and growth | Assuming they are a beginner | "Here's a perspective worth testing in your next strategy review." |
| The person carrying inclusion as an EDI lead or inclusion specialist (often isolated, under-resourced) | Practical and strategic solutions, evidence to influence leaders, resources for colleagues, ways to show impact | Recognise the complexity of the role; be practical, supportive and strategic; connect principles to organisational reality | Telling them what they should do without acknowledging the barriers | "You shouldn't have to figure it all out alone." |
| The person carrying inclusion as an HR or People professional with inclusion added to their role | Clear explanations, confidence, time-saving resources, a business case, ways to engage leaders | Make inclusion understandable and manageable; explain terms; link it to attracting, developing and retaining people | Assuming specialist knowledge; framing inclusion as an extra task | "Inclusion isn't separate from your people strategy. It's how it works." |
| Culture, People and Culture or OD lead | How inclusion shapes engagement, behaviours, change and everyday experience | Talk culture, behaviours, systems and measurement; connect to engagement and change programmes | Treating inclusion as a separate initiative from culture | "Your culture is what people experience on an ordinary Tuesday. Inclusion is part of that, not an add-on." |
| Social impact, ESG or sustainability lead | Credible evidence for impact reporting, the S in ESG, community and supply chain inclusion | Speak in outcomes, measures and accountability; be precise about what can be evidenced | Vague impact language or claims that won't survive scrutiny | "Inclusion belongs in your impact story when you can evidence what changed." |
| People manager | What to do differently on Tuesday morning | Specific behaviours, encouraging and direct | Theory without action | "Inclusion happens in the team meeting, not the boardroom." |
| The approver: HR director, chief people officer, chief executive, board member or budget holder | Risk, return, evidence and confidence the work will deliver | Lead with the business case, outcomes and governance; confident and concise | Moralising, jargon, vague promises | "What does it cost not to address this?" |
| Procurement and organisational buyers | Clear scope, outcomes, price, terms and safeguards | Specific, structured, commercially literate | Ambiguity about deliverables | "Here is what we'll deliver, by when, and how we'll measure it." |

| Audience | What they are looking for | How we speak to them | Avoid | Example line |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Schools and education leads | Timetable-friendly, practical, staff and student impact | Classroom and staffroom examples, warm and knowledgeable | Corporate examples that don't translate | "The culture educators build shapes how young people experience belonging." |
| Peers on Instagram | Inclusion as a society issue, not only a workplace one | Bold reframes, activist energy | Workplace jargon | "This isn't a workplace problem. It's a world problem." |

**Regional notes:** UK copy is the default. For Bermuda, use Bermudian examples and local context where relevant, and never assume UK law applies. For US readers, use DEI language, US spelling only in US-specific campaigns, and "accommodations" rather than "adjustments".

# Channels

Write LinkedIn first, then adapt outward. Each channel zooms the same idea in or out.

| Channel | Role | Voice | Shape |
|---|---|---|---|
| LinkedIn | Speaks to customers' workplace pain points | Professional, first person, confident | Hook line, short paragraphs, → lists, one question, bold AIEO definition sentence, three-tier hashtags |
| Blog | Thought leadership; zooms out to the wider issue | Considered, evidence-led | H2 sections, sources in a line, practical takeaways |
| Instagram | Activist voice for peers; reframes the issue as a society issue | Bold, energetic | Statement graphic, short caption |
| TikTok | Interactive, engaging video | Direct to camera, conversational | Start mid-thought, one idea, end on a question |
| Email and newsletter | Relationship and Resource of the Month | Warm, personal | One story, one resource, one action |
| Proposals and reports | Win and justify work | Formal, concise, outcome-led | Problem, approach, outcomes, investment |
| Impact Platform | Help members act | Calm, precise | Microcopy patterns below |

Public content can point to one route in (consultancy, training, membership, podcast or a resource) where it genuinely helps the reader, with one call to action. Many posts should simply end on insight or a question: a pitch at the end of everything erodes trust.

**Format notes:** the website tells visitors quickly who we are, what we do, who we support, why it matters and what to do next. Learning resources cover what the subject is, why it matters, what to consider, how it applies to the learner's role and what to do next, using real scenarios rather than lists of definitions. Proposals are specific about the client's challenge, the work, the approach, the outcomes and the value. Newsletters give people a reason to open, read and come back.

**Two looks, one voice (approved 6 November 2026):** the website and the Impact Platform look different on purpose (see Brand World and the Visual Brand Guide), and the words follow suit. Website copy is the shop window: confident, inviting and story led, with room for a headline that persuades and a line that reassures. Platform copy is the workspace: short, clear and action first, telling members what this is, what they get and what to do next. The voice stays the same in both. When improving an existing website page, change the words and fix anything broken or untrue, and leave the design exactly as it is unless Rebekah asks.

# Two voice profiles: website and platform (approved 9 November 2026)

**One voice, two jobs.** On the website we are the trusted expert: we prove we can be trusted with the work. On the Impact Platform we are the learning partner: we help members do the work. Both are always warm and competent. On the website, competence carries more weight, because it drives the decision to buy and purpose-led consultancies are assumed to be warm but less capable. On the platform, warmth carries more weight, because fear of getting it wrong is the biggest barrier to learning. The evidence behind every rule is in Website and Platform Voice Research.

| | Website: the trusted expert | Platform: the learning partner |
|---|---|---|
| Stance | "We know what works, and we will guide you" | "You can do this, and we are right here" |
| Job | Sell, reassure and position us as thought leaders who follow through | Teach, guide and build confidence while members do it themselves |
| Leads with | The buyer's problem and the outcome, then the proof | What you will learn or do, then the first small step |
| Proves competence through | Specific outcomes, named sectors, a clear process, credentials, sourced figures, real attributed testimonials | Accurate explanations, worked examples, real workplace scenarios, sources cited briefly |
| Shows warmth through | Writing about their situation, not about us; being easy to reach; naming what happens next | Normalising mistakes, recognising the step taken, giving choice over what comes next |
| Mistakes and gaps | Named as systems problems, never the reader's fault | Expected and useful: explain why, then invite another try |
| Calls to action | One primary action per section, naming the outcome | Verb first and immediate |
| Rhythm | Confident, story led, room for a headline that persuades | Short, clear, action first; objectives before content |

## Website voice rules

1. **Lead with their problem, then the outcome.** "Your managers want to get this right. We give them the tools to do it on Monday."
2. **Prove, don't claim.** Replace adjectives ("proven", "results-driven", "world-class") with a specific outcome, a named sector, a sourced figure or a real testimonial.
3. **Show the work.** Say what happens: who they work with, what week one looks like, what they receive.
4. **Keep it about them.** For every sentence about us, there should be more about them. Self-interest lowers trust, however impressive we sound.
5. **Insight before pitch.** Give a point of view on the sector's real challenge, so the page could be forwarded to a finance director or chief executive.
6. **One clear next step, matched to readiness.** A primary action (Book a Free Inclusion Call) with a lighter option beside it (Read the business case). Name the outcome on the button, never "Get started" or "Learn more".
7. **No pressure, no surprises.** No fake urgency. Say what things cost, or what shapes the cost, and what happens after someone clicks.
8. **Authority with warmth.** We are confident because we know the work, never superior. Systems, not blame.

## Platform voice rules

1. **Say what they will be able to do.** Every lesson and tool opens with a plain objective: "By the end, you will be able to..."
2. **Small steps, early success.** Get members to a first small win quickly; break long content into short parts.
3. **Mistakes are part of learning.** Say so openly, and mean it in the design: "Not quite. Here is why. Have another go."
4. **Feedback is about the task, never the person.** Explain why an answer is right or wrong and what to do next. Avoid "Great job!" and "You got it wrong".
5. **Recognise the step, not the trait.** "You spotted the bias in the shortlist", not "You're a natural ally".
6. **Invite, don't instruct.** Give choice over paths and next steps; frame members as part of the solution.
7. **Make progress visible.** Name small wins ("You have finished your first module") and show what is next.
8. **Bring it back to work.** End with a reflection or an if-then plan: "Next time someone says this in a meeting, I will..."
9. **Rewards recognise; they are not the reason.** Certificates and CPD records confirm real capability; never "Complete this to earn a badge".

## The same idea in each voice

| Moment | Website | Platform |
|---|---|---|
| Introducing training | "Inclusion training often fades within days. We design programmes your managers use the next week: practical tools, real scenarios and follow-up." | "In this lesson you will practise one conversation you can use this week. It takes about 15 minutes." |
| A gap or mistake | "Most organisations don't lack commitment; they lack the structure and support to act on it." | "Not quite. A reasonable adjustment is a legal duty, not a favour. Look at the example above, then try again." |
| Call to action | Book a Free Inclusion Call | Start Lesson |
| Recognition | "Trusted by organisations across the UK, Bermuda and the US" (with real names and outcomes) | "You have completed four of twelve. Next: Speaking Up." |
| Proof | "Recognised as an award-winning EDI consultancy by Corporate Vision" | "Based on research from the Chartered Institute of Personnel and Development" (when it is) |

**Avoid on the website:** vague claims, generic buttons, fake urgency, hidden costs, writing about us more than them.

**Avoid on the platform:** praise for the person, blame, long blocks of text before the first action, rewards as the point, anything that feels like a test you can fail.

**Website and platform copy that converts:**

- **Headline formula:** the outcome the reader wants, in their words ("Make the case for inclusion, and get it signed off"). Sub-headline: how we help, in one sentence. Then proof, then one action.
- **Write each page for two readers:** a line for the practitioner ("you're not alone") and a line for the budget holder ("here's the return").
- **Name the objection, then answer it:** "No budget line for EDI? Most of our members started the same way."

- **Search and AI visibility:** use the phrases buyers actually search (EDI consultancy UK, inclusion training, inclusive leadership, psychological safety at work) in headings naturally; include one clear standalone definition sentence per page so search engines and AI tools can quote us; write unique meta descriptions under 155 characters.
- **Pricing and process pages:** plain, specific and complete. Uncertainty about price or process reads as a lack of competence.

## Our spoken and audio voice

The brand voice carries into everything people hear: lesson narration, video voiceovers, audio summaries and the podcast.

- Sound natural, warm, confident and professional.
- Never robotic, exaggerated or artificial in delivery, and never childish or overly playful.
- Match the delivery to the subject: a serious topic gets a slower, more considered delivery; a lighter learning topic can be more conversational.
- Where a synthetic voice is used, tune it to the warmth of the brand and test it with members before it goes live.
- Consider Rebekah's own voice for introductions and key moments: it builds connection and authenticity in a way a generated voice cannot.
- Always give listeners control of playback speed, with a transcript and captions. Speed control is especially valued by neurodivergent members.

# Calls to action

Confident, natural and helpful: show the value of the next step without pressure.

| Context | Examples |
| --- | --- |
| Impact Platform | Explore the Impact Platform; Continue your learning; Find practical resources for your organisation |
| Consultancy | Start a conversation about your inclusion priorities; Let's explore what progress could look like for your organisation; Book a Free Inclusion Call |
| Content | Read the full guide; Explore the research; Take this question into your next team conversation; Share your perspective |

Never: false urgency, artificial scarcity, hard-sell language, "click here", or promises we cannot substantiate.

# Challenging conversations

We talk openly about racism and anti-racism, sexism, disability discrimination and ableism, LGBTQ+ inclusion, class, ageism, power and privilege, intersectionality, harassment and exclusionary practice. We never avoid an important conversation because it is uncomfortable, and we never provoke for attention.

When discussing a difficult subject:

1. Establish the context.
2. Explain why it matters.
3. Use evidence and relevant examples.
4. Recognise the human impact.
5. Challenge assumptions or practices where needed.
6. Offer a constructive route to reflection or action.

Direct without being dismissive; challenging without being antagonistic.

## Telling other people's stories

- Get informed consent before sharing anyone's story, quote or image, and let them check how it is used.
- Anonymise by default in case studies unless the client and the individual agree to be named.
- Tell stories with dignity: focus on systems and change, never on pain for effect.
- Credit lived experience, and pay people fairly for contributing it (podcast guests, panellists, co-designers).
- Never present one person's story as the experience of a whole group.

## Sensitive moments

- **Awareness days and months:** mark them only when we add something useful (a resource, an insight, a voice from that community) and link to year-round action. No logo-only posts.
- **Political climate and backlash:** stay calm, factual and evidence-led. Acknowledge the pressure people are under; never mock, catastrophise or take party-political positions. Focus on what organisations can do.
- **News and incidents:** pause scheduled posts when something serious happens; respond only when we have something constructive and informed to add.
- **When we get it wrong:** acknowledge it quickly and plainly, correct it, thank the person who raised it and say what we'll do differently. No defensiveness, no over-apology.
- **Criticism of our work:** respond once, with respect and substance; take detailed conversations offline.

# The business case, in sequence

**The business case stays central, and it always follows the person.** The person carrying inclusion already cares, but must persuade people who may not; the business case (culture, productivity, output, creativity, retention, profit) is the argument they take into the room. Leaders rarely act on it in the abstract; they act when someone in their own organisation brings it with a plan. So we use both, together, on every page:

1. **Open with their situation**, in plain words, so the person carrying inclusion knows the page is for them.
2. **Move straight to the business case:** what inclusion delivers, in outcomes, with credible attributed evidence.
3. **Show how we turn it into something they can use and take upward:** tools, evidence, support, progress they can report.
4. **Close with one outcome named call to action.**

Never lead with the business case alone (it tells a reader who already cares what they know), and never with empathy alone (it gives the approver no reason to say yes). The business case appears on every page; what changes is how much of the page it takes up.

| Where | How the two are balanced |
|---|---|
| Homepage | Opens with the person carrying inclusion; business case outcomes as the proof that follows; a short route for the approver |
| Business case page | Leads with the business case in full, written to be forwarded; closes by showing the person carrying inclusion how we help them make it |
| Platform and tool pages | Open with the task and the time saved; each tool names the business outcome it supports |
| Pricing page | Individual and Plus open with the person's situation and what it buys; the organisation section and approver panel lead with outcomes, return and reporting |
| Social and email | Hook on the situation; land on one business case point; one call to action |

**Where the money comes from:** never assume a dedicated EDI budget exists. Frame spend against budgets they can reach: learning and development, business support, people and culture.

**How we frame it:**

- Start from their goal (retention, performance, delivery, growth, risk), not from inclusion.
- Name the cost of the problem in their terms: leavers, absence, disengagement, grievances, lost ideas, lost customers.
- Show what inclusion changes and how it would be measured.
- Make the next step small and practical.
- Keep the human reason present in one line: fairness and dignity matter, and they also pay.

**The business case structure** (use for web pages, proposals, posts and Inclusion AI outputs):

1. **Their goal:** "You need to keep your best people."

2. **The cost today:** "Replacing one employee can cost between half and twice their salary."
3. **The evidence:** "People who feel they belong are far less likely to leave."
4. **What changes:** "Inclusive managers make belonging part of everyday work."
5. **What it takes:** "A 90-minute manager session and three practical tools."
6. **The next step:** "See what turnover is costing you now."

**Speak their language, not ours:**

| Instead of (inclusion language) | Try (business language) |
|---|---|
| Belonging | People who stay, contribute and recommend you |
| Psychological safety | Teams where people raise problems early, before they become expensive |
| Inclusive leadership | Managers who get the best from everyone on their team |
| Equity | Fair access to opportunity, so you don't lose talent you've paid to develop |
| EDI strategy | A plan to improve retention, performance and reputation |
| Lived experience | What your people are actually telling you |

Keep the inclusion terms where the audience uses them (inclusion leads, practitioners), and always explain them for everyone else.

**Never:** present inclusion as a cost, a trend or a PR exercise; overclaim (inclusion is one lever among several); or use a statistic without its source and its limits.

# Value in every ask

**Every time we ask for something, we state exactly what the person gets.** Name the benefit, the effort, and what happens next. Write it in the reader's language.

| The ask | Weak | Value-led |
|---|---|---|
| Email sign-up | "Subscribe to our newsletter" | "One practical inclusion insight and a ready-to-use resource every month. Five minutes to read. Unsubscribe anytime." |
| Free resource | "Download now" | "Get the one-page business case template your leadership team will actually read." Button: "Send Me the Template" |
| Pathway question | "Select your role" | "What's your role? We'll show you the three resources that save you most time." |
| Second pathway question | "What is your sector?" | "Which sector are you in? We'll use examples and benchmarks from organisations like yours." |
| Booking a call | "Contact us" | "Book a free 30-minute Inclusion Call. Leave with two priorities and a clear next step, whether or not you work with us." |
| Membership | "Join now" | "Get the tools, evidence and expert support to make the case and deliver change, from £249 a year." |
| Form helper text | (none) | "We only ask what we need to tailor this for you." |
| Confirmation | "Thank you for your submission" | "Your template is on its way. While you wait: [link to a relevant case study]." |

**Patterns:** button labels describe the outcome ("Show My Resources", "Build My Business Case"), never "Submit". Ask the minimum: name and email for a resource; more only when it clearly improves what they get. Say how their data is used in one plain line. Opt-outs are neutral ("Not now"), never guilt-tripping.

**Pricing copy:** lead with what each tier delivers, compare it with a cost the buyer recognises where the comparison is honest (for example, the cost of replacing one employee), and mark one tier as recommended for most organisations.

**Current membership tiers (placeholders until tested with real buyers):** Individual £249 a year (for the person carrying inclusion on their own); Practitioner Plus £449 a year (proposed; adds Inclusion AI tools and the health check and action plan); Growing Teams £2,400 a year (50 to 250 employees, 10 full seats); Established Organisations £4,800 a year (250 to 1,000 employees, 25 full seats); Enterprise from £7,500 a year (custom quote). New starters joining through an organisation link get the onboarding programme only, unless added as a named full seat. People move up from Individual to Plus when time becomes the problem, and to an organisation membership when they are ready, or asked, to bring others in or show progress upward: that is when the approver needs to hear from us directly. The October Pricing Strategy document is superseded by the Membership Tiers and Pricing document.

> **Internal note: review before launch.** These are the prices currently on the Impact Platform and are used here as placeholders only. Following the November 2026 business meeting with Sean, prices are to be reconsidered and likely raised. Update this guide, the Visual Brand Guide and the platform pricing page together once new prices are agreed.

# Business case evidence bank

Use these figures with their source and limits, and check them again before each use. Where possible, pair them with the organisation's own data.

| Claim | How to say it | Source | Limits |
|---|---|---|---|
| Cost of a leaver | Replacing an employee can cost one-half to two times their annual salary | Gallup | US-based estimate; varies by role |
| Belonging and performance | High belonging is linked to a 56% increase in job performance, a 50% drop in turnover risk and 75% fewer sick days | BetterUp, 2019 | Survey-based association |
| Managers matter most | Managers account for at least 70% of the variance in team engagement | Gallup | Engagement, not inclusion specifically |
| Inclusive culture | Inclusive cultures are reported as twice as likely to meet financial targets and six times more likely to be innovative | Deloitte, via HCAMag | Self-reported organisational survey |
| Diverse leadership | Top-quartile gender diverse executive teams were 39% more likely to outperform financially | McKinsey, 2023 | Association only; replication challenged by Green and Hand, 2024 |
| Accessibility and revenue | Disabled shoppers who click away from inaccessible UK websites hold £17.1bn in spending power | Click-Away Pound, 2019 | Retail, 2019 data |
| HR capacity | HR is primarily responsible for DEIB in over half of organisations, yet two-thirds of HR teams spend 20% or less of their week on it; only 37% of UK and Ireland organisations have dedicated DEIB roles | HR.com, 2023; Lattice, 2025 | HR.com is mainly US respondents; Lattice figure is UK and Ireland. Retire the old 62% and 5% figure: no original source could be found |

# Platform, lessons and Inclusion AI

## Microcopy patterns

| Element | Pattern | Example |
|---|---|---|
| Primary button | Verb first, Title Case, 1 to 3 words | Start Lesson, Build My Case, Save Resource |
| Secondary button | Softer verb | Preview, Maybe Later |
| Empty state | What it is, then the first action | "Nothing saved yet. Tap the save icon on any resource to keep it here." |
| Error | What happened, what to do, no blame | "We couldn't save that. Check your connection and try again." |
| Success | Short, specific | "Saved to your dashboard." |
| Locked module | Why, and how to unlock | "Complete Lesson 2 to open this one." |
| Quiz feedback | Explain, never judge; everyone moves forward | "Not quite. Bias often shows up in who we ask first. Here's why." |
| Form helper text | Plain reason for asking | "We use your sector to tailor examples." |

## Lessons

- Learning objective: one sentence, platform voice. Learning outcomes: three bullets starting with action verbs, in the learner's voice ("I can spot...").
- Define terms inline where they appear; repeat the core definition on slides 2, 6 and 9.
- Questions are past and present tense when they ask about the learner's own workplace; avoid "would you".
- No certificates mentioned in single lessons; certificates belong to modules.

## Inclusion AI voice

Inclusion AI speaks as The Inclusion Edit: an expert colleague, using "we" for the organisation and "you" for the member.

- Answer first, then explain. Use the member's sector, size and barrier in the output.
- Structure outputs in labelled boxes (what this means, what to do next, how to get sign-off).
- Ground claims in platform research and case studies; cite in a short line. Never invent statistics or sources; say plainly when evidence is limited.
- Not legal advice: flag when a question needs an employment lawyer or HR policy owner, and note jurisdiction (UK, Bermuda, US).
- Same writing rules as everything else: British English, no dashes, sentence case, gains-based framing.
- Stay neutral on party politics; be clear and confident on the value of inclusion.

## Inclusion AI tool cards and page copy (approved 6 November 2026)

AI tools are marked by what they do, so the words on each card carry the difference. Every tool card has three pieces of copy:

- **Tagline:** one line, gain first, in plain words. "Remove bias before your role goes live."
- **You give:** what the member brings, in a few words and in their language. "A job description", "Your gender pay gap figures", "An existing policy".
- **You get:** what they leave with, concrete and checkable. "An equity review with rewritten wording ready to use", "A 12-month framework with objectives and a board-ready summary".

Rules for You give and You get: take both lines from what the tool genuinely does; never promise more, never use "instantly", "perfect" or "guaranteed"; no dashes; no full stops at the end of the lines.

**How Inclusion AI works** (the three steps on the Inclusion AI page, worded to keep the member in control):

1. **Tell us your context:** share your role, your organisation and what you need to achieve.
2. **The tool does the groundwork:** it applies EDI expertise and evidence to your situation.
3. **You get a draft to check and adapt:** every result is a starting point; review it, edit it and make it yours.

**Hero badge copy:** "Inclusion AI", "Specialist AI Tools", "Purpose-built for inclusion work", "Evidence-backed". The tool count is always the real number of tools listed.

## Writing with AI: protecting our voice

AI can help research, structure and draft, but it must never become the voice of The Inclusion Edit. Every AI draft is reviewed against this guide before it is used.

| AI must | AI must not |
|---|---|
| Use British English and no dashes | Make everything sound polished and corporate |
| Follow the five characteristics and suit the audience and channel | Remove personality, conviction or challenge |
| Use clear, natural, specific language | Add generic motivational lines or filler to make content longer |
| Stay evidence-informed and inclusive | Invent research, statistics, quotes or testimonials |
| Preserve the meaning of the original | Overuse rhetorical questions or exclamation marks |
| Vary sentence rhythm | Make every sentence sound the same |
| Keep claims supportable | Turn every piece into a sales pitch, or assume more formal means more professional |

**The instruction:** prioritise authenticity, clarity and substance over sounding impressive. The result should read as if an experienced inclusion professional wrote it, not an AI writing assistant.

**Writing samples:** keep a small library of Rebekah's own writing that sounds most like her (a LinkedIn post, a newsletter, a training explanation, a consultancy email). Give these to Claude alongside this guide so it learns the rhythm, not just the adjectives.

**Distinctive, never generic.** Our content must never feel generic, formulaic or obviously AI-generated. Board feedback was that some areas read as if they had come straight from Claude. Every piece needs at least one of: a specific example, a real scenario, a clear point of view or a line only The Inclusion Edit would write. People should recognise our expertise and personality, not feel they are reading another generic AI explanation.

# Before and after

| Generic | The Inclusion Edit | Why |
|---|---|---|
| "Diversity and inclusion are increasingly important in today's workplace. Organisations must embrace diversity to unlock the full potential of their employees." | "Inclusion is not achieved simply by having a diverse workforce. It is shaped by the decisions, behaviours and systems that determine whether people have fair opportunities to contribute, progress and belong." | Systems, not slogans |
| "Organisations should prioritise inclusive leadership to create a positive workplace culture." | "An organisation's culture is shaped by what its leaders tolerate, reward and challenge. Inclusive leadership shows in the decisions leaders make, not just what they say." | Specific and challenging |
| "We provide innovative solutions to empower businesses on their diversity and inclusion journey." | "We help organisations understand where they are, identify what needs to change and make inclusion part of how they operate." | Says what we actually do |
| "Everyone has a role to play. Let's work together to make a difference." | "Everyone has a role to play, but responsibility needs to be matched with accountability." | Adds the harder truth |
| "Are you ready to transform your organisation and unlock the power of inclusion?" | "Does your organisation have the knowledge, confidence and tools to turn its inclusion commitments into action? That's where we can help." | A real question, no hype |
| "We are committed to delivering holistic, best-in-class EDI solutions." | "We help organisations move from good intentions to lasting inclusion." | Plain words, a real outcome |
| "Inclusion isn't a quota — it's culture." | "Inclusion isn't a quota. It's culture." | No dashes |
| "Our platform offers 200+ resources." | "Find the template you need for Thursday's leadership meeting." | Gains, not features |
| "Error 403: unauthorised." | "This page is for members. Sign in or start your membership." | Helpful, no blame |
| "BAME staff are underrepresented in leadership." | "Black and South Asian colleagues are underrepresented in leadership." | Specific groups |

# Final checklist

- [ ] Does it sound like The Inclusion Edit, and could Rebekah say it aloud to a client?
- [ ] Is it written for the person carrying inclusion (they, them or you, no titles as labels), and does it pass the forward test: could they send it to their director unedited, and would the director find a reason to act?
- [ ] Does the first sentence say the point, and is the message clear?
- [ ] Does it show knowledge and credibility while respecting the reader's intelligence?
- [ ] Is the language accessible, with terms explained and nothing that assumes expertise?
- [ ] Does it feel human and natural, not corporate or AI-generated?
- [ ] Does it challenge or provoke thought where appropriate?
- [ ] Does it open with the situation of the person carrying inclusion, then bring in the business case and the value to the reader: a gain, a next step or an insight?
- [ ] Is every stat sourced, dated and not overstated; every testimonial real?
- [ ] Does it look at systems, not just individuals?
- [ ] British English, no dashes, correct capitalisation, our terminology and product names?
- [ ] One call to action at most, with its value stated, and no false urgency or guilt-tripping?
- [ ] Does it reflect our values, and would we be comfortable putting our name to it?
- [ ] Is it warm without being patronising, and does it respect what the reader already knows?
- [ ] Does it show we understand the reality of the reader's role and constraints?
- [ ] Does it include a specific example, scenario or point of view that makes it unmistakably ours?
- [ ] If it will be heard, does it sound natural read aloud, with speed control, captions and a transcript?

# Before this guide is final

1. **Test it with real people.** Share sample website copy, a platform explanation and a LinkedIn post with the 12 customer testers and ask whether the language feels credible, understandable and relevant to their role.
2. **Check the balance.** The biggest risks are sounding too corporate in trying to be professional, or too academic in trying to show expertise.
3. **Build the writing sample library** described in the AI section.